



'We have to use our workforce to develop sports goods manufacturing'

— Raksha Khadse



GO TO THE
CONCLAVE PLAYLIST

Raksha Khadse, Minister of State, Sports, Government of India during the Sportstar Conclave in Patna. R.V. MOORTHY

Team Sportstar

Raksha Khadse, Minister of State, Sports, Government of India said that the Sports Ministry wants to place emphasis on the development of sports goods manufacturing in India.

Delivering the Keynote Address at the *Sportstar Focus Bihar Conclave*, Khadse said, "We see so much workforce from Bihar, we can take that into sports as well which can contribute to the state's growth. We want to develop sports goods manufacturing in India.

"We have to rely on getting it from other countries. But if we can do this in our states, then we can take sports to every household." Khadse also added that the government wants to work with States to use technology and use sports science to train athletes.

"I am trying my best to work with States, in my capacity as Minister of State, to try and develop sporting ecosystems in India. Because in 2036 when we host the Olympics, when we win medals, I want to feel happy that I

played a part.

"Most states are not aware of sports science. It is very important. It is a way to prepare athletes better and give them a platform early on. Sports is no longer about just playing for jobs. It might be in some places but we have to change that and encourage to make sports a livelihood. We have to work on how we can get that support in place since school. At times, athletes do not get that support in the initial stages. We have to change that.

Khadse, three-time Member of Parliament, also highlighted the Government of India's efforts in increasing the participation of women in India's sporting ecosystem.

"We have started the ASMITA (Achieving Sports Milestone by Inspiring Women Through Action) Leagues since 2021 for women, where they can participate in sports. We want women to get the same number of medals as men in international events. I am delighted to inform that on March 8, in 250 districts we organised ASMITA Leagues where over two lakh women took part," Khadse said.

"The honourable Prime Minister

has also tried to reserve 26 per cent positions for women in sports federations, right from the district level to the national level."

Appreciating Bihar for its efforts to reach the grassroots level with sporting infrastructure, Khadse said, "I am always elated to come to Bihar, the vision this State has, especially Mr. Raveendran Sankaran, Director General cum CEO, Bihar State Sports Authority, the passion you have, I have not seen in any other State. You are trying to take that forward. I do not agree that Bihar is a backward State. Bihar will be a booming sports hub. We have to develop the system and take it forward, and we have been able to start that with the international events that you hosted. I have to appreciate you for using the MNREGA to develop sports infrastructure in smaller districts.

You put that idea up at the Chintan Shivar with the honourable Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, and we have put that in the sports budget as well. This will be used at a central government level now to uplift the rural areas across the country in sports."